

ACTAM PRO

Project Framework

A web-based real-time audio workstation where the browser controls musical events and Python renders the sound.

WEB CONTROLS

BACKEND SOUNDS

REAL-TIME DSP

Browser UI

HTML / CSS / JavaScript
Instrument panels, keyboard,
effects, sequencer

WebSocket

Lightweight JSON messages
note_on, note_off, param,
switch

Python Engine

AudioEngine manages voices,
mixing, FX, and recording

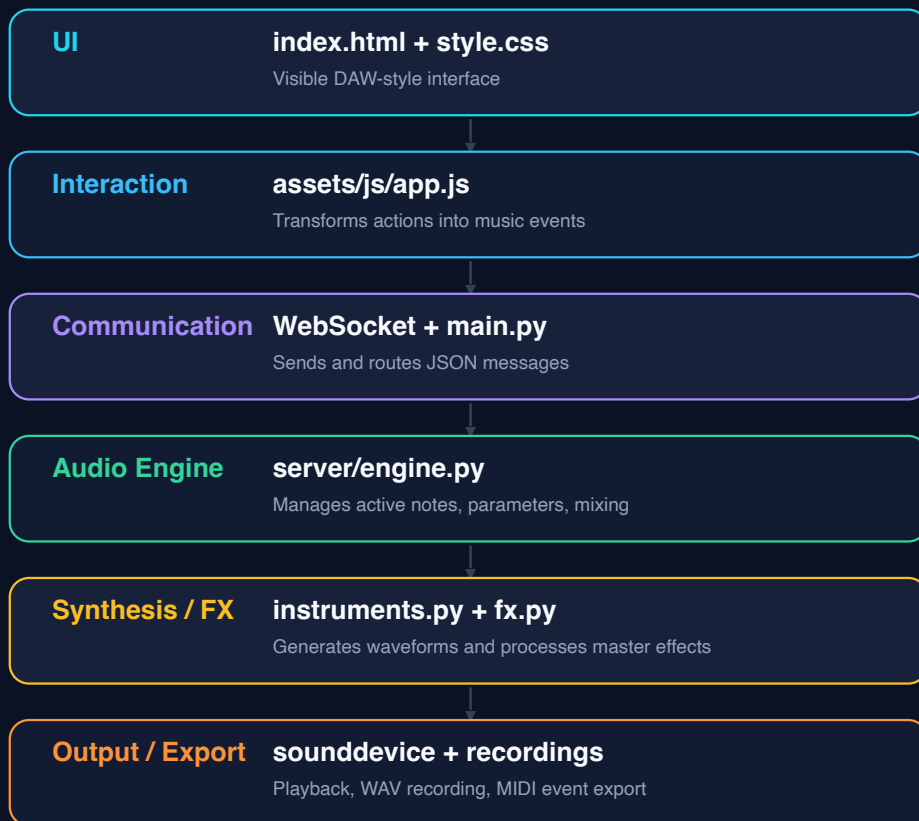
Audio Output

sounddevice stream
WAV and MIDI export

Saeid Soleimani, 11024150, saeid.soleimani@mail.polimi.it
Hanxiang Gao, 11088786, hanxiang.gao@mail.polimi.it

Project Layers and Signal Flow

LAYERED DESIGN



Runtime control path

- 1 User action in browser
- 2 app.js creates event object
- 3 AudioClient sends JSON
- 4 main.py routes message
- 5 engine.py updates state
- 6 audio_callback outputs block



Frontend Module

Role: interface + event organization

The frontend decides what the user wants to play, then sends structured control messages to the backend.

AudioClient.send()

ACTAMServer.ws_handler()

index.html

Defines the DAW layout: instrument panels, virtual keyboard, drum machine, effects area, recording controls, and arrangement section.

style.css

Builds the visual identity: responsive layout, panels, buttons, grids, and modern workstation look.

app.js

Captures inputs, manages sequencer timing, smart chords, arrangement events, and WebSocket communication.

app.js/AudioClient

Connects to ws://localhost:8765 and sends JSON object

Frontend input sources

- Keyboard or mouse playing
- Instrument and effects controls
- Drum pattern grid
- Arrangement playback and capture

```
noteOn(baseMidi) {
  if (!this.isPlayable) return;

  // --- INTERCEPT: KBD CHORD MODE ---
  if (this.keyboardChordMode && this.activeVst !== 'drums') {
    this.playChordFromRoot(baseMidi, true);
    return;
  }

  let actualMidi = this.activeVst === 'drums' ? baseMidi : baseMidi + (this.octaveShift * 12);
  if (this.activeSet.has(actualMidi)) return;

  this.activeSet.add(actualMidi);
  this.playedNotes.set(baseMidi, actualMidi);
  if (this.keyElems[baseMidi]) this.keyElems[baseMidi].classList.add('active');

  const freq = this.midiToFreq(actualMidi);
  this.client.send({ type: 'note_on', id: actualMidi, freq: freq, vst: this.activeVst });
  if (this.arrangement) this.arrangement.recordNoteOn(this.activeVst, actualMidi, 1);

  if (this.activeVst === 'guitar') this.updateFretboard(actualMidi, true);
  if (this.activeVst === 'strings') this.updateViolinStrings(actualMidi, true);
  this.updateDisplay();
}
```

note_on

note_off

chord_on/off

switch

param

start/stop_recording

```
{
  type: "note_on",
  id: 60,
  freq: 261.63,
  vst: "piano",
  velocity: 1.0
}
```

Smart Chords

Frontend music-theory layer. It builds scale notes and chord structures, then sends multiple notes as one musical event.

```
initChordPads() {
  this.chordTypes = {
    'Maj': [0, 4, 7], 'Min': [0, 3, 7], 'Dim': [0, 3, 6],
    'Aug': [0, 4, 8], 'Sus4': [0, 5, 7], 'Sus2': [0, 2, 7]
  };
  this.noteNames = ['C', 'C#', 'D', 'D#', 'E', 'F', 'F#', 'G', 'G#', 'A', 'A#', 'B'];

  // Diatonic Scale Formulas
  this.scaleFormulas = {
    'Major': [
      { int: 0, type: 'Maj', num: 'I' }, { int: 2, type: 'Min', num: 'ii' },
      { int: 4, type: 'Min', num: 'iii' }, { int: 5, type: 'Maj', num: 'IV' },
      { int: 7, type: 'Maj', num: 'V' }, { int: 9, type: 'Min', num: 'vi' },
      { int: 11, type: 'Dim', num: 'vii°' }
    ],
```

```
this.padConfigs = Array(7).fill().map(() => ({ rootIdx: 0, type: 'Maj', octave: 3, numeral: '' }));

// Init Global Selectors
const globRoot = document.getElementById('globalKeyRoot');
const globScale = document.getElementById('globalKeyScale');
if (globRoot && globScale) {
  this.noteNames.forEach((n, idx) => {
    let opt = document.createElement('option');
    opt.value = idx; opt.textContent = n;
    globRoot.appendChild(opt);
  });
  globRoot.addEventListener('change', () => this.applyGlobalKey());
  globScale.addEventListener('change', () => this.applyGlobalKey());
}

this.renderChordPads();
this.applyGlobalKey(); // Auto-calculate C Major on startup
```

Sequencer + Drum Machine

BPM-based 16th-step timing,
swing, humanized velocity/delay,
and three-state drum cells: off,
normal, accent.

```
getTimeParts() {
  const [beats, unit] = this.timeSignature.value.split('/').map(Number);
  return { beats: beats || 4, unit: unit || 4 };
}
```

```
getStepMs() {
  const bpm = parseInt(this.bpmInput.value) || 120;
  return ((60 / bpm) * 1000) / 4;
}
```

```
class Sequencer {
  constructor(client) {
    this.client = client;
    this.audioCtx = new (window.AudioContext || window.webkitAudioContext)();
    this.seqInterval = null;
    this.currentStep = 0;
    this.playingStep = 0;
    this.lastStepTime = 0;
    this.isPlaying = false;
    this.isRecording = false;
    this.clickEnabled = true;
    this.drumMachineEnabled = true;
    this.drumLoopEnabled = true;
    this.drumPresetStoragePrefix = 'actamDrumPreset: ';
    this.legacyCustomDrumPresetKey = 'actamCustomDrumPreset';
    this.activeDrumPreset = 'empty';
    this.hasUnsavedDrumChanges = false;
    this.activePatternSlot = 'A';
    this.patternSlots = { A: null, B: null };
    this.swingAmount = 0;
    this.humanizeEnabled = false;
    this.fillStepsRemaining = 0;
    this.fillStartStep = 0;
    this.onPatternChange = null;
    this.drumLanes = [
      { id: 'crash', label: 'CRASH', note: 49, key: 'R' },
      { id: 'ride', label: 'RIDE', note: 51, key: 'Y' },
      { id: 'openhat', label: 'OPEN HAT', note: 46, key: 'C' },
      { id: 'hihat', label: 'CLOSED HAT', note: 42, key: 'X' },
      { id: 'hitom', label: 'HI TOM', note: 48, key: 'F' },
      { id: 'midtom', label: 'MID TOM', note: 45, key: 'G' },
      { id: 'floortom', label: 'FLOOR TOM', note: 41, key: 'V' },
      { id: 'snare', label: 'SNARE', note: 38, key: 'S' },
      { id: 'kick', label: 'KICK', note: 36, key: 'SPACE' }
    ];
  }
}
```

```
cell.addEventListener('click', () => {
  this.drumPattern[lane.id][step] = (this.drumPattern[lane.id][step] + 1) % 3;
  this.markDrumPatternEdited();
  this.renderDrumMachine();
  this.notifyDrumPatternChanged();
}));
```

scheduleNextStep()

```
if (this.clickEnabled && isBeatStep) this.playClick(this.currentStep === 0);
if (this.drumMachineEnabled) this.playDrumStep(this.currentStep);
if (this.arrangement) this.arrangement.handleTick();
if (this.fillStepsRemaining > 0) {
  this.fillStepsRemaining -= 1;
  if (this.fillStepsRemaining === 0) this.updateFillButton();
}
this.updateDrumPlayhead();

const nextStep = this.currentStep + 1;
const stepDelay = this.getSwingStepMs(this.currentStep);
if (nextStep >= totalSteps && !this.drumLoopEnabled) {
  this.seqInterval = setTimeout(() => this.togglePlay(), stepDelay);
  return;
}

this.currentStep = nextStep % totalSteps;
this.seqInterval = setTimeout(() => this.scheduleNextStep(), stepDelay);
}
```

Sequencer + Drum Machine

BPM-based 16th-step timing,
swing, humanized velocity/delay,
and three-state drum cells: off,
normal, accent.

```
playDrumStep(step) {
  this.drumLanes.forEach(lane => {
    const state = this.drumPattern[lane.id] ? this.drumPattern[lane.id][step] : 0;
    if (state) this.playDrumLaneAtStep(lane, step, state);
  });
  this.playFillStep(step);
}

playDrumLaneAtStep(lane, step, state) {
  const baseVelocity = state === 2 ? 1 : 0.68;
  const velocity = this.getHumanizedVelocity(baseVelocity);
  const delay = this.getHumanizedDelay();
  const trigger = () => {
    this.triggerDrum(lane.note, velocity);

    const cell = this.drumMachine ? this.drumMachine.querySelector(`.dm-cell[data-lane="${lane.id}"][data-step="${step}"]`) :
    if (cell) {
      cell.classList.add('triggered');
      setTimeout(() => cell.classList.remove('triggered'), 95);
    }
  };
}
```

```
triggerDrum(midiNote, velocity = 1) {
  if (!this.client) return;
  this.client.send({ type: 'note_on', id: midiNote, freq: 0, vst: 'drums', velocity });
  const pad = document.querySelector(`.drum-pad[data-note="${midiNote}"]`);
  if (pad) {
    pad.classList.add('active');
    setTimeout(() => pad.classList.remove('active'), 80);
  }
}
```

Arrangement Draft

8-bar MIDI-like workspace storing track, MIDI note, start time, duration, velocity.

```
class Arrangement {
  constructor(client, sequencer) {
    this.client = client;
    this.sequencer = sequencer;
    this.bars = 8;
    this.tracks = ['piano', 'strings', 'guitar', 'drums'];
    this.trackColors = {
      piano: '#33ff99',
      strings: '#ffcc66',
      guitar: '#55ccff',
      drums: '#ff6677'
    };
  };
  this.notes = this.tracks.reduce((acc, track) => ({ ...acc, [track]: [] }), {});
  this.activeTakes = new Map();
  this.recording = false;
  this.playheadStep = 0;
  this.lastTickStep = 0;
  this.lastTickAt = performance.now();
  this.playingNotes = [];
  this.editor = { track: null, bar: 0, selected: null };
  this.storageKey = 'actamArrangementDraft';
  this.initDOM();
}
```

```
getBarSteps() {
  return this.sequencer.getTotalSteps();
}

getTotalSteps() {
  return this.getBarSteps() * this.bars;
}

getStepMs() {
  return this.sequencer.getStepMs();
}

getLoopMs() {
  return this.getTotalSteps() * this.getStepMs();
}

stepToMs(step) {
  return step * this.getStepMs();
}

msToStep(ms) {
  return Math.max(0, Math.min(this.ge
```

```
handleTick() {
  const step = this.getCurrentStep();
  this.lastTickStep = step;
  this.lastTickAt = performance.now();
  this.startNotesInWindow(this.stepToMs(step), this.stepToMs(step + 1), step);
  this.renderPlayhead();
  this.playheadStep = (this.playheadStep + 1) % this.getTotalSteps();
  this.updateStatus();
}
```

startNotesInWindow()

```
const wrapped = endMs >= loopMs;
const windowEnd = endMs % loopMs;
this.tracks.forEach((track, trackIndex) => {
  this.notes[track].forEach((note, index) => {
    const inWindow = wrapped
      ? note.startMs >= startMs || note.startMs < windowEnd
      : note.startMs >= startMs && note.startMs < endMs;
    if (!inWindow) return;

    const offset = wrapped && note.startMs < windowEnd
      ? (loopMs - startMs) + note.startMs
      : Math.max(0, note.startMs - startMs);
    setTimeout(() => this.playNote(track, trackIndex, note, step, index), offset);
  });
});
```

Arrangement Draft

8-bar MIDI-like workspace storing track, MIDI note, start time, duration, velocity.

```
playNote(track, trackIndex, note, step, index) {
  if (track === 'drums') {
    this.client.send({ type: 'note_on', id: note.midi, freq: 0, vst: 'drums', velocity: note.velocity || 1 });
    return;
  }

  const playId = 90000 + trackIndex * 100000 + step * 100 + index;
  this.client.send({ type: 'note_on', id: playId, freq: this.midiToFreq(note.midi), vst: track, velocity: note.velocity || 1 });
  const timer = setTimeout(() => {
    this.client.send({ type: 'note_off', id: playId });
    this.playingNotes = this.playingNotes.filter(item => item.playId !== playId);
  }, Math.max(35, note.durationMs || this.getStepMs()));
  this.playingNotes.push({ ...note, playId, timer });
}
```

```
recordNoteOn(track, midi, velocity = 1) {
  if (!this.recording || !this.tracks.includes(track) || track === 'drums') return;
  const key = `${track}:${midi}`;
  if (this.activeTakes.has(key)) return;
  this.activeTakes.set(key, {
    track,
    midi,
    velocity,
    startMs: this.getCurrentMs()
  });
}
```

```
recordNoteOff(track, midi) {
  if (!this.recording || !this.tracks.includes(track) || track === 'drums') return;
  const key = `${track}:${midi}`;
  const take = this.activeTakes.get(key);
  if (!take) return;
```

```
  this.activeTakes.delete(key);
  const endMs = this.getCurrentMs();
  let durationMs = (endMs - take.startMs + this.getLoopMs()) % this.getLoopMs();
  if (durationMs < 35) durationMs = 120;
  this.addNote(take.track, take.midi, take.startMs, durationMs, take.velocity);
}
```

```
addNote(track, midi, startMs, durationMs, velocity = 1, shouldRender = true) {
  const startStep = this.msToStep(startMs);
  const durationSteps = Math.max(1, Math.round(durationMs / this.getStepMs()));
  const note = {
    id: `${Date.now()}_${Math.random().toString(16).slice(2)}`,
    midi,
    startMs,
    durationMs,
    startStep,
    durationSteps,
    velocity
  };
  this.notes[track].push(note);
  this.sortTrack(track);
  if (shouldRender) this.render();
}
```

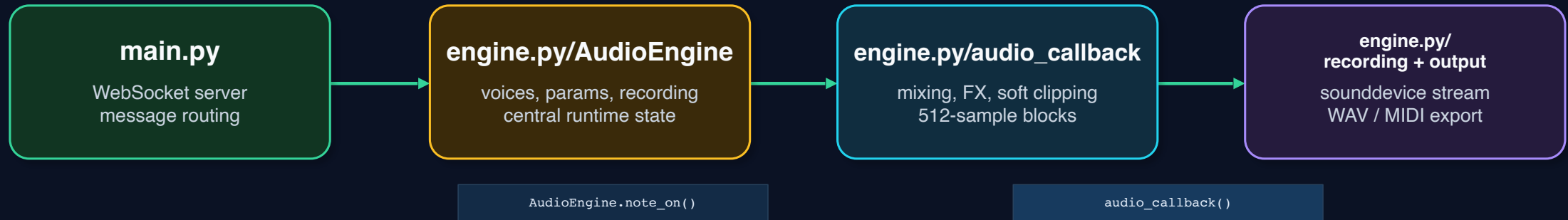
```
captureDrumPattern(sequencer, targetBar = this.getCurrentBarIndex()) {
  if (!sequencer) return;
  targetBar = Math.max(0, Math.min(this.bars - 1, targetBar));
  sequencer.ensureDrumPatternLength();
  const barMs = this.getLoopMs() / this.bars;
  const barStartMs = targetBar * barMs;
  const barEndMs = barStartMs + barMs;
  const barSteps = this.getBarSteps();

  this.notes.drums = this.notes.drums.filter(note => note.startMs < barStartMs || note.startMs >= barEndMs);
  sequencer.drumLanes.forEach(lane => {
    const pattern = sequencer.drumPattern[lane.id] || [];
    pattern.forEach((state, step) => {
      if (!state) return;
      this.addNote('drums', lane.note, this.stepToMs(targetBar * barSteps + step), this.getStepMs(), state ===
    ));
  });
  this.render();
}
```


Backend Module

Role: communication router + real-time audio engine

The backend receives JSON messages, updates engine state, generates audio blocks, applies effects, and records output.



STATE UPDATE

```
note_on → active_notes[id] = {data, pos, on, rel_pos, vst, midi_note, base_speed, gain}
```

AUDIO BLOCK CHAIN

```
audio_callback(): read active voices -> interpolate -> mix -> apply FX -> tanh soft clipping -> outdata
```

Instrument Synthesis

Piano

Additive synthesis:

Multiple partials are summed with exponential decay and slight inharmonicity for a synthetic piano tone

```
partials = [
    (1, 1.000, 0.35), (2, 0.720, 0.88), (3, 0.510, 1.75),
    (4, 0.350*brt, 3.10), (5, 0.240*brt, 4.90), (6, 0.160*brt, 7.20),
]
```

```
sig = np.zeros(n_samp, dtype=np.float32)
for h, amp, d0 in partials:
    fh = f0 * h * float(np.sqrt(1.0 + B * h * h))
    sig += amp * np.sin(2 * np.pi * fh * t) * np.exp(-d0 * (0.75 + 0.50 * norm) * t)
```

```
f0 = self.midi2freq(midi_note)
N = max(2, int(round(self.sr / f0)))
exc = np.random.default_rng(int(midi_note)).standard_normal(N).astype(np.float64)
a_coef = np.zeros(N + 2, dtype=np.float64)
a_coef[0], a_coef[N], a_coef[N+1] = 1.0, -0.495, -0.495
x_buf = np.zeros(n_out, dtype=np.float64)
x_buf[:N] = exc
output = lfilter([1.0], a_coef, x_buf).astype(np.float32)
```

```
try:
    sos_lp = butter(2, 7000 / (self.sr/2), btype='low', output='sos')
    warm = sosfilt(sos_lp, output.astype(np.float64)).astype(np.float32)
    output = 0.72 * output + 0.28 * warm
except Exception: pass
```

Strings

Supersaw-style ensemble pad:

Detuned oscillators, vibrato, slow attack, and filtering

```
f0 = self.midi2freq(midi_note)
sig = np.zeros(n_samp, dtype=np.float32)

vibrato = 0.003 * np.sin(2 * np.pi * 5.0 * t)

for d in [-0.15, 0.0, 0.15]:
    freq = f0 + (f0 * d * 0.01)
    phase = np.cumsum((freq * (1.0 + vibrato)) / self.sr)
    sig += (2.0 * (phase % 1.0) - 1.0) * 0.3

attack_len = int(0.25 * self.sr)
if attack_len > 0 and len(sig) > attack_len:
    sig[:attack_len] *= np.linspace(0.0, 1.0, attack_len, dtype=np.float32)

try:
    sos = butter(2, 4000 / (self.sr/2), btype='low', output='sos')
    sig = sosfilt(sos, sig)
except Exception: pass
```

Guitar

Plucked-string physical modeling:
Noise excitation circulates through a feedback delay with low-pass energy loss

Drums

Procedural drums. Envelopes, sine waves, noise, and filtering

```
if midi_note == 36: # Kick
    freqs = 150.0 * np.exp(-30.0 * t) + 40.0
    sig = np.sin(2 * np.pi * np.cumsum(freqs / self.sr)) * np.exp(-4.0 * t)
elif midi_note == 38: # Snare
    tone = np.sin(2 * np.pi * 180 * t) * np.exp(-12.0 * t)
    noise = np.random.normal(0, 1, len(t)) * np.exp(-25.0 * t)
    try:
        sos = butter(2, 1000 / (self.sr/2), btype='high', output='sos')
        noise = sosfilt(sos, noise)
    except Exception: pass
    sig = tone + (noise * 0.8)
elif midi_note in [42, 46]: # Hi-Hat
    decay = 35.0 if midi_note == 42 else 5.0
    noise = np.random.normal(0, 1, len(t))
    try:
        sos = butter(4, 5000 / (self.sr/2), btype='high', output='sos')
        sig = sosfilt(sos, noise) * np.exp(-decay * t)
    except Exception: pass
elif midi_note in [41, 45, 48]: # Toms
    base_freq = 60.0 if midi_note == 41 else (100.0 if midi_note == 45 else 150.0)
    freqs = (base_freq * 1.5) * np.exp(-10.0 * t) + base_freq
    sig = np.sin(2 * np.pi * np.cumsum(freqs / self.sr)) * np.exp(-3.0 * t)
elif midi_note in [49, 51]: # Cymbals
    decay = 2.5 if midi_note == 49 else 4.0
    noise = np.random.normal(0, 1, len(t))
    try:
        sos = butter(2, [3000/(self.sr/2), 8000/(self.sr/2)], btype='band', output='sos')
        sig = sosfilt(sos, noise) * np.exp(-decay * t)
    except Exception: pass
```

Instrument Synthesis

```
def precompute(self, notes: list):
    # 1. Check if a cache file exists for this specific instrument
    cache_file = f"cache_{self.__class__.__name__.lower()}.pkl"

    if os.path.exists(cache_file):
        print(f" [Cache] Loading {self.__class__.__name__} from disk...")
        with open(cache_file, 'rb') as f:
            self.library = pickle.load(f)
        return

    # 2. If no cache, perform heavy DSP generation
    print(f" [DSP] Generating {self.__class__.__name__}...")
    for m in notes:
        self.library[m] = self.generate_note(...)

    # 3. Save the result to disk for the next time
    with open(cache_file, 'wb') as f:
        pickle.dump(self.library, f)
```

```
self.instruments = {
    "piano": Piano(sr),
    "guitar": Guitar(sr),
    "strings": Strings(sr),
    "drums": Drums(sr)
}

# NOTE: Using range(24, 105, 3) to compute only every 3rd note!
self.instruments["piano"].precompute(range(24, 105, 3))
self.instruments["guitar"].precompute(range(24, 105, 3))
self.instruments["strings"].precompute(range(24, 105, 3))
self.instruments["drums"].precompute([36, 38, 41, 42, 45, 46, 48, 49, 51])
```

Precomputation strategy

- For non-drum instruments, the nearest precomputed MIDI note is selected and the playback speed is adjusted to match the requested pitch.
- For drums it precomputes a fixed set of MIDI drum hits.

```
else:
    actual_midi = round(12 * np.log2(max(freq, 8.0) / 440.0) + 69)
    remainder = actual_midi % 3
    if remainder == 1:
        root_note = actual_midi - 1
        pitch_offset = 1 # Shift up 1 semitone
    elif remainder == 2:
        root_note = actual_midi + 1
        pitch_offset = -1 # Shift down 1 semitone
    else:
        root_note = actual_midi
        pitch_offset = 0

    base_speed = float(2.0 ** (pitch_offset / 12.0))
```

```
for nid, note in list(self.active_notes.items()):
    data, pos, dlen = note['data'], float(note['pos']), len(note['data'])
    if int(pos) >= dlen - 2:
        dead.append(nid); continue

    total_speed = speed * float(note.get('base_speed', 1.0))

    frac_idx = pos + np.arange(frames, dtype=np.float32) * total_speed
    int_idx = frac_idx.astype(np.int64)
    np.clip(int_idx, 0, dlen - 2, out=int_idx)
    frac = (frac_idx - int_idx).astype(np.float32)
    chunk = data[int_idx] * (1.0 - frac) + data[int_idx + 1] * frac

    if not note['on'] and self.current_vst != "drums":
        rel_t = float(note['rel_pos']) + np.arange(frames, dtype=np.float32) / self.sr
        chunk *= np.exp(-18.0 * rel_t)
        note['rel_pos'] = float(rel_t[-1])
        if note['rel_pos'] > 0.40: dead.append(nid)

    mixed += chunk * float(note.get('gain', 1.0))
```

Real-time DSP and Effects

FX are applied on the master bus after all active notes are mixed



Tremolo

LFO-controlled volume modulation:
It changes loudness over time

```

t_rel = self.lfo_phase + np.arange(n, dtype=np.float32) / self.sr
lfo = 1.0 - depth * (0.5 - 0.5 * np.cos(2.0 * np.pi * rate * t_rel))
self.lfo_phase = float(t_rel[-1]) % (1.0 / max(rate, 0.01))
  
```

Delay

Circular buffer echo:
Past audio is read back after a delay time
and repeated with feedback.

```

d_samp = max(1, int(delay_time * self.sr))
read_idx = (self.delay_wptr - d_samp + np.arange(n, dtype=np.int64)) % self.delay_maxn
delayed = self.delay_buf[read_idx]
write_idx = (self.delay_wptr + np.arange(n, dtype=np.int64)) % self.delay_maxn

self.delay_buf[write_idx] = sig + feedback * delayed * 0.97
self.delay_wptr = int((self.delay_wptr + n) % self.delay_maxn)

out = sig + level * delayed
  
```

Reverb

Several comb-filter delay lines simulate
dense reflections and spatial tail

```

rev = np.zeros(n, dtype=np.float32)

for i, dlen in enumerate(self.rev_comb_d):
    idx = (self.rev_cptrs[i] + np.arange(n, dtype=np.int64)) % dlen
    comb_out = self.rev_cbufs[i][idx]
    self.rev_cbufs[i][idx] = sig + 0.84 * comb_out
    self.rev_cptrs[i] = int((self.rev_cptrs[i] + n) % dlen)
    rev += comb_out

rev *= 0.125
return ((1.0 - mix) * sig + mix * rev).astype(np.float32)
  
```

Evaluation

Strengths

- Clear frontend/backend separation
- WebSocket-to-audio path
- Multiple synthesis methods
- Sequencer, chords, arrangement, recording

Future improvements

- Individual FX and recording
- Better MIDI tempo/track metadata
- More realistic instruments
- Web-based application